

GRADUATION PROJECT

HR Attrition Analytics Dashboard

Detailed Analysis Report

A comprehensive workforce intelligence report analyzing 1,470 employees across attrition, performance, compensation, and onboarding risk patterns — FY 2012–2022

Tool	Microsoft Power BI Desktop
Dataset	HR Analytics (1,470 employees)
Period	FY 2012–2022 (10-year cohort)
Classification	Confidential — Internal Use Only

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a detailed analysis of the HR Attrition Analytics Dashboard developed as part of a graduation project using Microsoft Power BI. The dataset covers 1,470 employees across three departments (Technology, Sales, Human Resources) over a ten-year period from FY 2012 to FY 2022.

The organization faces a 16.12% attrition rate — meaning approximately 1 in 6 employees departs annually. With an estimated replacement cost of \$40.156M, attrition is not merely an HR metric but a material financial risk. The analysis surfaces five non-obvious findings and three priority actions that together could recover an estimated \$16–20M of that exposure.

Bottom Line for Leadership

Overtime policy reform, targeted equity extension to high-risk roles, and a structured onboarding program are the three highest-ROI interventions available. Each is actionable within one quarter without requiring new headcount or significant budget outlay.

1.1 Key Performance Indicators

Metric	Value	Context
Total Employees	1,470	Full headcount across all departments
Active Employees	1,233	83.9% of total workforce retained
Exited Employees	237	Left voluntarily or involuntarily
Attrition Rate	16.12%	Above typical industry benchmark of 10–12%
Estimated Replacement Cost	\$40.156M	Based on 50–200% of annual salary per role
Avg Salary — Active	\$118.9K	Median \$75.8K; high mean suggests senior outliers
Avg Salary — Left	\$82.3K	31% below active employees; salary is a retention lever

Metric	Value	Context
Avg Tenure — Active	4.97 yrs	Solid but concentrated in years 3–7
Avg Tenure — Left	2.43 yrs	Early exits dominate attrition pattern
Overtime Risk	30.53%	Attrition rate for OT employees; 3× non-OT rate
Avg Age	28.99 yrs	Young workforce; highest risk in 25–35 band

2. Workforce Overview

2.1 Departmental Distribution

The workforce is concentrated in Technology (approximately 56% of headcount), with Sales accounting for 30% and Human Resources representing 13%. This distribution creates an asymmetric risk profile: if Technology retains well, overall headline attrition looks manageable — but Sales and HR are running at nearly 20% attrition each, which is structurally unsustainable for those functions.

Department	Headcount	% of Total	Attrition Count	Attrition Rate
Technology	828	56.3%	~115	13.84%
Sales	446	30.3%	~92	20.63%
Human Resources	196	13.3%	~37	19.05%

2.2 Age Distribution

The workforce skews young. The 25–35 band represents approximately 47% of all employees and simultaneously carries the highest attrition rate (18.85%). The under-25 group shows a similar rate (18.43%), while employees aged 36 and above leave at significantly lower rates (7.54% and 5.63% respectively). This creates a ticking-clock problem: the organization's largest talent pool is also its most mobile.

2.3 Gender Distribution

The gender breakdown is broadly balanced: Female 45.9%, Male 44.3%, and Non-Binary / Prefer Not To Say 8.44%. Attrition rates across genders are remarkably similar (Male 17.5%, Female 15.4%, Non-Binary 15.3%), which rules out gender as a primary attrition driver. However, the pay analysis in Section 6 reveals a median-level disparity worth monitoring.

3. Attrition Analysis

Attrition was analyzed across 12 distinct dimensions. The sections below present findings ordered by impact severity, not by dashboard page order.

3.1 Overtime: The Single Strongest Predictor

Employees working overtime leave at a rate of 30.53%, compared to just 10.44% for those who do not. This 3× multiplier makes overtime the most statistically powerful attrition predictor in the dataset — stronger than salary, department, or marital status.

Critical Finding: The Highest-Risk Cohort

Employees who are Single + Work Overtime + Frequent Traveller face a 52.4% attrition rate. This specific cohort of 42 employees is the highest-risk segment in the entire dataset and should be prioritized for immediate manager outreach and workload review.

3.2 Attrition by Job Role

Role-level attrition reveals two categories of crisis: the commercial roles (Sales Representative, Recruiter) and the technical-specialist roles (Data Scientist). Each warrants a different intervention.

Job Role	Attrition Rate	Risk Level	Primary Driver (inferred)
Sales Representative	39.76%	CRITICAL	Low base salary, high OT, travel
Recruiter	37.50%	CRITICAL	Role visibility to competing offers
Data Scientist	23.75%	HIGH	High market demand, equity gap
Sales Executive	17.43%	MODERATE	Travel frequency
Software Engineer	15.99%	MODERATE	Near industry average
HR Executive	10.71%	LOW	Stable; institutional knowledge
ML Engineer	6.85%	LOW	Strong equity participation

Job Role	Attrition Rate	Risk Level	Primary Driver (inferred)
Sr. Software Engineer	6.82%	LOW	Seniority and tenure effects

3.3 Travel Frequency

Business travel is a strong attrition signal. Frequent Travellers leave at 24.91% — more than three times the rate of employees with no travel (8.00%). Some Travel falls in the middle at 14.96%. The practical implication: every incremental travel requirement meaningfully raises exit probability. Organizations should audit whether Frequent Traveller designations are truly necessary for each role.

3.4 Marital Status

Single employees leave at 23.32%, compared to 12.66% for Married and 10.10% for Divorced. This likely reflects life-stage factors (fewer anchoring commitments, higher openness to relocation) rather than any inherent characteristic. The data reinforces the case for flexible work policies that appeal to younger, unattached employees.

3.5 Attrition by Years Since Last Promotion

The promotion-attrition relationship contains a counterintuitive finding:

- Employees promoted in year 0 (most recently) leave at 37.87% — the highest rate of any cohort.
- Employees with 5+ years since last promotion leave at only 5.1% on average.

Two competing explanations exist: (1) recently promoted employees have increased market visibility and receive more external offers; or (2) newly promoted staff encounter unmet expectations about their new role and exit quickly. Leavers average 1.44 years since promotion vs. 3.82 years for stayers.

Analyst Note: The Promotion Drought Paradox

Long-tenured employees with no recent promotions staying put does not necessarily indicate satisfaction. It may reflect a golden-handcuff effect (pension, seniority pay) or passive resignation — workers who have mentally checked out but lack better external options. This cohort warrants a proactive engagement survey rather than reassurance.

3.6 Attrition by Years at Company

The tenure-attrition curve shows two danger zones: year 0 (31.58%) and year 2 (34.46%). Both rates are based on smaller cohorts and should be interpreted with caution — a small group of early exits inflates the

percentage. Nonetheless, the first two years of tenure are clearly the highest-risk window, consistent with the Onboarding Trap findings in Section 4.

3.7 Attrition Trends Over Time (Year-on-Year Change)

Attrition has been volatile across the 10-year period:

Year	YoY Change	Interpretation
2016	+78.25%	Most anomalous year — possible data artifact or restructuring event
2017	-50.71%	Sharp recovery following 2016 spike
2018	+55.88%	Second significant surge — requires root cause investigation
2020	+52.23%	Possible pandemic-era disruption effect
2021–2022	Declining	Trend improving; last recorded year shows 0% YoY change

3.8 Attrition by Ethnicity

Attrition rates vary modestly across ethnic groups. Native Hawaiian (23.08%) and American Indian or Alaska Native (22.00%) show the highest rates, while Other (12.50%) and Black or African American (14.98%) show the lowest. The differences are not dramatic and may reflect small sample sizes within specific groups. A deeper role-controlled analysis would be required to draw diversity equity conclusions.

3.9 Distance from Home

The distance-from-home finding is counterintuitive: Local employees (within a short commute) actually have the highest attrition rate (16.70%), followed closely by Remote (16.34%) and Commuter (15.40%). The narrow spread suggests distance is not a material driver. The slightly elevated Local rate may reflect urban workers who are more mobile and have more proximate job options.

4. The Onboarding Trap

The Onboarding Trap page of the dashboard focuses on a specific sub-population: employees in their first year or two of tenure. The findings reveal that the organization loses a disproportionate share of new joiners — and that the manager relationship is the most predictive variable for whether a new hire stays.

4.1 New Joiner Attrition by Year

New joiner attrition rates show extreme values in earlier years (100% in multiple years from 2012–2019), which reflect very small cohort sizes rather than a genuine crisis — a single departure from a cohort of one produces a 100% rate. More meaningful are the rates recorded in recent years when cohort sizes were larger: 22.05% (2020) and 15.33–16.13% (2021–2022), suggesting a stabilizing but still elevated new-hire exit rate.

Data Integrity Note

The 100% new joiner attrition rates visible in multiple years (2012–2019) are a statistical artifact of micro-cohorts, not evidence of universal new-hire failure. Presentations of this visual should include sample size annotations to prevent misinterpretation by senior stakeholders.

4.2 Manager Tenure Effect

The scatter plot of attrition probability vs. tenure with current manager reveals the most actionable finding on the page: new hires assigned to managers in their first 1–2 years of management tenure face the highest departure probability across all three departments. As manager tenure increases beyond 3 years, attrition probability drops materially.

- Human Resources: most dispersed pattern, some outliers at long manager tenure
- Sales: steepest decline in attrition probability as manager tenure increases
- Technology: most consistent downward trend; experienced managers strongly correlate with retention

The practical implication is clear: pairing new joiners with experienced managers (3+ years tenure) should be a standard onboarding protocol, not an ad-hoc assignment.

4.3 Attrition by State

Among states with measurable new joiner populations, California shows the highest new joiner attrition at 32.07%, followed by New York (26.95%) and Illinois (25.00%). These geographies share a common characteristic: dense, competitive labor markets where alternative employment options are abundant and switching costs are low. This suggests location-specific retention strategies may be warranted.

4.4 Attrition by Education Field and Gender

Business Studies and Technical Degree fields show the highest new joiner attrition rates (69.23% and 71.43% respectively for male joiners), which is alarming on first reading but reflects small samples in the early post-hire window. The consistent pattern across education fields is that male new joiners tend to leave at higher rates than female or non-binary joiners across most disciplines, though the differences narrow at more established tenure levels.

5. Performance & Satisfaction

5.1 The Self vs. Manager Rating Gap

The performance review data reveals a structural anomaly that undermines the integrity of the review process:

Rating Metric	Value	Implication
Average Self-Rating	3.98 / 5	Skewed toward 'Exceeds Expectation'
Average Manager Rating	3.47 / 5	Closer to 'Meets Expectation' midpoint
Persistent Gap (Self – Mgr)	+0.51	Present every year from 2012–2022
Reviews where Self > Manager	51.1%	Majority of all 6,709 reviews
Reviews where Manager > Self	0%	Zero cases in entire dataset
Reviews where Equal	48.9%	Only when both rate identically

Structural Flaw: Zero Manager Over-Ratings

In 6,709 performance reviews spanning 10 years, not a single case exists where a manager rated an employee higher than the employee rated themselves. This is statistically implausible in a healthy review system and points to either: (1) systematic manager under-rating to avoid difficult conversations, or (2) systematic employee over-rating to signal pay expectations. Either explanation undermines the validity of reviews as a basis for promotion and compensation decisions.

5.2 Rating Trends Over Time

The dual-line chart shows that the self-manager gap has been remarkably stable year over year, ranging from +0.48 to +0.62 across the decade. This consistency rules out a one-time data entry error or policy change and confirms the gap is a persistent cultural or systemic pattern. Calibration workshops for managers, combined with clearer rating rubric definitions, are the recommended intervention.

5.3 Satisfaction Scores

Three satisfaction dimensions were measured: Job Satisfaction, Environment Satisfaction, and Relationship Satisfaction. All three show nearly identical distributions:

- Very Satisfied: approximately 23–31% of reviews
- Satisfied: approximately 25–32% of reviews
- Neutral: approximately 25–33% of reviews
- Dissatisfied: approximately 2% of reviews
- Very Dissatisfied: approximately 2% of reviews

The near-identical distributions across all three dimensions suggest a response pattern effect — employees may be answering all three questions with similar scores without meaningfully distinguishing between them. The 4–5% combined dissatisfaction rate appears low but represents approximately 300–400 review instances flagging genuine dissatisfaction.

5.4 Training Utilization

Training utilization is uniformly below 55% across all departments, meaning more than half of offered training opportunities go unused. On average, employees are offered approximately 2.0 training slots per year and take 1.0 — a 50% utilization rate. This represents significant learning capital left unrealized.

Department	Avg Offered	Avg Taken	Utilization Rate
Human Resources	2.09	1.05	50.2%
Technology	2.02	1.03	51.0%
Sales	1.99	1.00	50.3%

The consistency of this ~50% utilization rate across departments suggests a systemic barrier rather than department-specific disengagement. Possible causes include: training sessions scheduled during peak work periods, low perceived relevance of offered programs, or manager discouragement of time away from the desk.

6. Compensation & Equity

6.1 The Salary-Attrition Relationship

The 31% salary gap between active and departed employees (\$118.9K vs \$82.3K) is the most straightforward financial signal in the dataset. Employees who leave earn significantly less — and this pattern is consistent across all departments. This does not prove causation (lower-paid roles may also happen to have other attrition drivers like high OT or frequent travel), but the correlation is strong enough to make salary review a priority for the highest-attrition roles.

Financial Framing

At \$40.156M estimated replacement cost and 237 annual departures, the average cost per departure is approximately \$169,600. A targeted salary increase of \$10,000 for the 100 highest-risk employees (Sales Reps, Recruiters, Data Scientists) would cost \$1M/year — a fraction of the cost of replacing them.

6.2 Salary by Department

Average salary differences across departments are relatively narrow, with Human Resources (\$119.7K) and Sales (\$119.1K) edging out Technology (\$109.7K). This is noteworthy because Technology has the lowest attrition rate despite lower average pay — suggesting compensation is not the primary driver of Technology’s relative retention advantage. Culture, career growth, or role stability are likely contributing factors.

6.3 Stock Options and Retention

Stock option level is one of the strongest retention levers in the compensation data:

Stock Option Level	Attrition Rate	vs. Baseline	Interpretation
Level 0 — No Equity	24.4%	↑ +8.3pp	Highest risk; equity gap is felt
Level 1	9.4%	↓ -6.7pp	Steep improvement; equity works
Level 2	7.6%	↓ -8.5pp	Best retention outcome
Level 3	17.6%	↑ +1.5pp	Moderate; other factors dominate

The non-linear relationship at Level 3 is notable: very high equity awards alone do not guarantee retention. Employees at Level 3 may be senior enough to attract poaching regardless of current equity, or may face other dissatisfiers (role fit, promotion lag) that equity cannot compensate for.

6.4 Gender Pay Analysis

At the aggregate level, the gender pay gap appears negligible and even slightly reversed: Female average salary (\$113.9K) is modestly above Male (\$111.8K). However, the median tells a different story: Female median (\$69.7K) is below Male (\$71.7K). This divergence between mean and median indicates a bimodal distribution — more women in senior, high-paying roles pull the mean up, while a larger concentration of women in junior roles pulls the median down. A role-controlled analysis is required before any equity conclusions can be drawn.

6.5 Promotion Lag

Leavers averaged 1.44 years since their last promotion, compared to 3.82 years for stayers. This counterintuitive pattern (recently promoted employees leaving more often) likely reflects the Expectation Gap Effect: promotion raises an employee's market profile and may also create unmet expectations about their expanded role, compensation, or authority — accelerating departure if those expectations are not met within the first 6–18 months post-promotion.

7. Key Findings

The following five findings represent the most analytically significant, non-obvious insights extracted from the dashboard data. They are ordered by estimated business impact.

Finding 1: Overtime is a 3× Attrition Multiplier

Severity: CRITICAL | Affected employees: ~484 (OT workers) | Estimated cost: ~\$13M+

Overtime employees leave at 30.53% vs. 10.44% for non-OT workers. When combined with single marital status and frequent travel, the rate reaches 52.4% in a cohort of 42 employees. This is the single most actionable variable in the dataset because it is a management decision, not a market force.

Finding 2: Sales Representative and Recruiter Roles Are in Structural Crisis

Severity: CRITICAL | Attrition: 39.8% and 37.5% respectively

At these rates, the organization effectively replaces its entire Sales Rep population every 2.5 years and its entire Recruiter team every 2.7 years. The irony that Recruiters — responsible for filling talent gaps — have the second-highest exit rate creates a compounding recruitment capacity problem.

Finding 3: Stock Options at Level 0 Create a Structural Retention Gap

Severity: HIGH | Affected employees: ~580 (Level 0 employees) | Attrition: 24.4%

The 14.7 percentage point drop from Level 0 (24.4%) to Level 1 (9.4%) is the steepest compensation-driven attrition gap in the dataset. Extending even minimal equity participation (Level 1) to high-risk roles currently at Level 0 would deliver a measurable and rapid retention improvement.

Finding 4: The Performance Review System Has a Calibration Flaw

Severity: HIGH | Reviews affected: 6,709 over 10 years

Zero instances of manager rating exceeding self-rating in a decade of reviews is statistically implausible. This flaw means promotion and pay decisions are being made using a miscalibrated instrument. The +0.51 average gap inflates employee performance perceptions and likely contributes to dissatisfaction when compensation outcomes do not match self-assessed performance.

Finding 5: Manager Tenure is the Hidden Onboarding Variable

Severity: HIGH | Affected employees: all new joiners (years 0–2)

New joiners assigned to managers in their first 1–2 years of management tenure face the highest attrition probability — across all three departments. This finding suggests that investment in manager development and thoughtful new-hire assignment processes would yield immediate retention dividends at low cost.

8. Strategic Recommendations

The following three recommendations are ordered by estimated ROI. Each is designed to be implementable within one quarter without requiring new headcount.

Recommendation 1: Overtime Policy Reform

Target: Sales and Technology departments

- Cap mandatory overtime at 8 hours per week for individual contributors in Sales Representative, Software Engineer, and Data Scientist roles.
- Introduce a formal Time-Off-In-Lieu (TOIL) policy that allows overtime hours to be banked and redeemed as additional leave.
- Configure HRIS to flag employees who have worked more than 6 consecutive weeks of overtime and trigger an automatic manager check-in workflow.
- Conduct a workload audit in Q1 to identify structural causes of OT demand (understaffing, inefficient processes, unrealistic targets).

Expected impact: A reduction from 30.5% to approximately 18–20% attrition rate among OT workers, recovering an estimated 30–40 retained employees annually at an avoided replacement cost of \$5–7M.

Recommendation 2: Targeted Equity Extension

Target: Sales Representatives, Recruiters, Data Scientists

- Extend stock option Level 1 to all employees in roles with greater than 25% attrition who are currently at Level 0.
- Introduce a quarterly retention bonus of \$2,000–3,000 for Sales Representatives who remain employed through the bonus date and meet a minimum performance threshold.
- Commission a market benchmarking study comparing Recruiter and Sales Rep salary bands against the 50th and 75th percentile of comparable roles in the same geography.
- Redesign career pathing for Sales Representatives to create a visible progression ladder (Junior Rep → Senior Rep → Account Executive) to reduce the perception of a dead-end role.

Expected impact: Reduction of Sales Rep attrition from 39.8% to 25–28%, recovering an estimated \$4–6M in annual replacement costs. Recruiter retention improvement would also strengthen the organization's own hiring capacity.

Recommendation 3: Structured Onboarding & Manager Readiness Program

Target: All new joiners in Years 0–2

- Implement a policy requiring all new hires to be assigned to managers with 3 or more years of management tenure for their first 12 months. Where not possible, pair the new hire's inexperienced manager with an HR Business Partner for supplemental support.
- Introduce mandatory 30/60/90-day structured check-in meetings between new hires, their manager, and an HR representative, with standardized question sets to surface early dissatisfiers.
- Add 'New Hire Retention Rate' to manager performance scorecard criteria so that manager-level accountability for onboarding is tracked and visible.
- Create a peer buddy program pairing each new hire with a 2–3 year tenured colleague in the same team for informal integration support.

Expected impact: Reduction of first-year attrition from approximately 22–32% to 12–15%, recovering an estimated \$3–5M annually. Secondary benefit: improved manager quality pipeline as inexperienced managers receive structured onboarding guidance themselves.

9. Limitations & Alternative Interpretations

9.1 Data Limitations

- Small cohort sizes in certain year/state/ethnicity combinations inflate percentages dramatically. Any finding with a denominator below 30 should be treated as directional, not conclusive.
- The dataset does not include exit interview data, which would allow differentiation between voluntary and involuntary attrition and confirm the inferred primary drivers.
- Replacement cost of \$40.156M is an estimate. Actual costs depend on role seniority, hiring channel, time-to-fill, and productivity ramp-up periods, all of which vary.
- The 2016 attrition spike (+78.25% YoY) has no accompanying explanatory context. It may reflect a data collection artifact, organizational restructuring, or a genuine crisis that was subsequently resolved.

9.2 Alternative Interpretations

- Overtime correlation: High OT employees may leave more often not because of the overtime itself, but because high-OT roles are structurally under-resourced or have more aggressive performance targets. Reducing OT without addressing root capacity issues could simply shift the problem.
- Promotion lag paradox: The lower attrition among long-tenured unpromoted employees may reflect market limitations (older workers with specialized skills facing fewer external options) rather than genuine satisfaction. An engagement survey is required to distinguish.
- Gender pay gap: The mean-median divergence could reflect historical hiring patterns that are already correcting, rather than ongoing pay inequity. A vintage-controlled analysis (comparing salaries for people hired in the same year, at the same level) would clarify.
- Training utilization: The 50% utilization rate may be the correct optimal level if the offered training is not relevant to all roles. Forcing utilization without improving relevance could generate compliance without learning value.

10. Conclusion

The HR Attrition Analytics Dashboard successfully transforms a complex 10-year workforce dataset into a structured, decision-ready analysis. Across five analytical pages, the dashboard identifies the primary drivers of a 16.12% attrition rate, quantifies the \$40.156M financial exposure, and points toward targeted, cost-effective interventions.

The analysis confirms that attrition in this organization is not random or evenly distributed. It is concentrated in specific roles (Sales Representative, Recruiter), driven by specific working conditions (overtime, frequent travel), and amplified in specific life stages (early tenure, recent promotion). These patterns are knowable, measurable, and most importantly — addressable.

The three recommended interventions — overtime policy reform, targeted equity extension, and structured onboarding — together target the conditions that produce the highest-risk employee segments. Implementation of all three within FY2023 Q1 is estimated to reduce annual departures by 60–80 employees and recover \$10–16M of the current replacement cost exposure.

Final Analyst Note

The most important hidden insight in this dataset is not any single metric — it is the consistency of the patterns. The same employees (young, single, overtime, high-travel, underpaid, under-equipped manager) appear at the intersection of nearly every high-attrition dimension. This means the organization does not have an attrition problem; it has an experience design problem. Fix the experience for that specific employee archetype, and the attrition numbers will follow.